Infobits

Parasites having direct life cycle

Protozoa	Helminths
• *Giardia lamblia*	• *Ascaris lumbricoides*
• *Trichomonas vaginalis*	• *Trichuris trichiura*
• *Balantidium coli*	• *Ancyclostoma duodenale*

Parasites having indirect life cycle

S.No	Protozoa	Definite host	Intermediate host
1.	*Plasmodium spp.*	Female *Anopheles* mosquito	Man
2.	*Toxoplasma gondii*	Cat	Man
3.	Cestodes *Taenia solium*	Man	Pig
4.	Trematodes *Fasciola hepatica*	Man	Snail
5.	Nematodes *Wuchereria bancrofti*	Man	Mosquito

various complex metabolic activities such as digestion, reproduction, respiration and excretion.

3. Each cell consists of nucleus and cytoplasm.
4. A protozoa parasite during its life cycle may exist in two stages such as trophozoite and cyst.

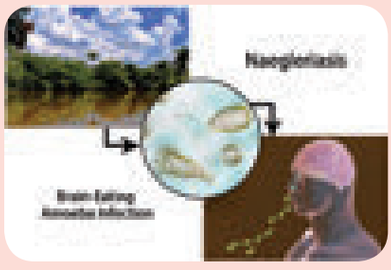
Amoebae

Amoebae are structurally simple protozoans which have no fixed shape. The cytoplasm of amoeba is bounded by a membrane and can be differentiated into an outer ectoplasm and inner endoplasm. Pseudopodia (false foot) are formed by the amoebae by throwing out ectoplasm followed by endoplasm. These are employed for locomotion and engulfment of food by phagocytosis.

Reproduction occurs by fission and budding. Amoebae are classified as either free living or intestinal amoebae.

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Naegleria fowleri (Brain eating amoeba) is a thermophilic, free living amoebae occasionally act as human pathogens producing meningoencephalitis known as primary amoebic meningoencephalitis (PAM). Infections most often occur when water containing *Naegleria fowleri* is inhaled through the nose, where it then enters the nasal and olfactory nerve tissue traveling to the brain. *N. fowleri* occurs in three forms -as a cyst, trophozoite (amoeboid) and a biflagellate (it has two flagella). The flagella form can exist in the cerebrospinal fluid.



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